

Xin He

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Employment

2024.09 -	University of Science and Technology of China <i>Tenure-Track Associate Professor of Finance, Faculty of Business for Science and Technology</i> <i>Faculty Affiliate, School of Management</i>
2022.09 - 2024.07	Hunan University <i>Assistant Professor, College of Finance and Statistics</i>

Education

2018 - 2022	City University of Hong Kong <i>Ph.D. in Management Sciences</i> Advisor: Prof. Guanhao Feng, Prof. Junbo Wang
2014 - 2018	Shanghai Jiao Tong University <i>B.S. in Industrial Engineering</i>

Research Interest

Asset Pricing, Financial Econometrics, Financial LLM, Financial Machine Learning, Quantitative Investment

Publication

1. “Growing the Efficient Frontier on Panel Trees” with Lin William Cong, Guanhao Feng, and Jingyu He.
Journal of Financial Economics, 2025, 167, 104024.
Award: 2022 INQUIRE Europe Research Grant Award, 2024 IQAM Research Prize
Media Coverage: [FBS](#), [IIF](#), [IIF WeChat](#), [XueShuo](#), [Tsinghua Financial Review](#),
2. “Predicting Individual Corporate Bond Returns” with Guanhao Feng, Yanchu Wang, and Chunchi Wu.
Journal of Banking & Finance, 2025, 171, 107372.
Media Coverage: [XueShuo](#)
3. “The Bright Side of Cross Ownership: Evidence From the Corporate Resilience to COVID-19 Crisis in China” with Yihui Chen and Haoyuan Wei.
International Review of Finance, 2025, 25(1), e12468.
4. “The Risk of Finance Words” with Xinbo Chen and Bowen Du.
Asia-Pacific Journal of Accounting & Economics, forthcoming, 2026+.

Working Paper

Apr. 2026	Factor Investing and the Integration of Equity and Corporate Bond Markets • with Xinlei Hao, Junbo Wang, and Yuanzhi Wang.
Feb. 2026	Stochastic Discount Factors with Cross-Asset Spillovers • with Doron Avramov. • Award: 2025 INQUIRE Europe Research Grant Award, 2025 Best Paper Award at SYSU Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech.
Jan. 2026	Optimal Portfolios with Trading Costs: The Case of Asset Spillovers
Apr. 2026	Generative Portfolio Selection, Transaction Cost, and Panel Tree
Apr. 2026	Characteristic-Based Benchmarks Revisited: Panel Tree Benchmarks for Corporate Bond Returns and Mutual Fund Evaluation
Jan. 2026	Corporate Bond Pricing via Panel Trees
July. 2025	AI Applications and the Opportunistic Insider Trading of Executives: Evidence from China • with Shuqi Zhang, Along Liu, Jibao Gu. • Revise & Resubmit.
Nov. 2025	When Competitors Go Public: Innovation Spillovers through Competitive Pressure and Learning Channels • with Yihui Chen, Zeyi Wu, Zhilin Wu. • Revise & Resubmit.
Oct. 2024	Firm Engagement in Belt and Road Initiative and the Cross-Section of Stock Returns: Evidence from China • with Yihui Chen, Jinsheng Liao, and Xiaojuan Wang.

Reference

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Grant

2026 - 2026	PI, University of Science and Technology of China Youth Innovation Fund Cross-Predictability in Empirical Asset Pricing: Theory and Evidence.
2026 - 2026	PI, University of Science and Technology of China Global Initiative Fund Pricing Corporate Bond Returns with Panel Tree.
2023 - 2025	Co-Investigator, General Research Fund at Hong Kong Research Grants Council - with Jingyu He (PI) and Guanhao Feng (Co-I). - Regression Tree for Portfolio Optimization and Imbalanced Data.
2022 - 2024	Co-Investigator, General Research Fund at Hong Kong Research Grants Council - with Guanhao Feng (PI), and Junbo Wang (Co-I). - Textual Analysis of Corporate Bond Market.

Award

2025	Best Paper Award, Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech, Sun Yat-sen University
2025	INQUIRE Europe Research Grant Award
2024	IQAM Research Award
2024	Best Paper Award, Session for Corporate Finance and Accounting, 10th Jingshi Scholar Forum, Tsinghua University
2023	Outstanding Advisor for Undergraduate Thesis, Hunan University
2022	INQUIRE Europe Research Grant Award
2021	Best Paper Award, Graduate Student Forum on Economics & Finance, Antai College, SJTU
2021	College of Business PhD Student Conference Grant, City University of Hong Kong
2018-2022	Ph.D. Studentship, City University of Hong Kong
2016	Second Prize, National Contest of Industrial Engineering Applications, Tsinghua University
2015,2016,2017	Academic Excellence Award, Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Teaching

USTC	* Students' evaluation in the parentheses. - Empirical Asset Pricing. MF. 2026 Spring (None) - Empirical Asset Pricing. MS. 2026 Spring (None) - Financial Institutions and Financial Market. BS. 2026 Spring (None) - Lectures on Financial Engineering and Advanced Topics. 2025 Spring (None)
Hunan University	- Simulation and Experiments in Financial Engineering. 2023 Summer (None) - Fixed-Income Securities. 2023 Autumn (98.00/100) - Behavioral Finance. 2023 Autumn (97.73/100)
Universities and Financial Institutions	Guest Speaker: Asset Pricing and Quantitative Investment

Service

Ad Hoc Referee	Management Science, Journal of Banking & Finance, Journal of Empirical Finance, Journal of Finance and Data Science, Journal of Financial Econometrics, Journal of Financial Markets, Annals of Operations Research, Asia-Pacific Journal of Accounting and Economics, Asia-Pacific Journal of Operations Research, Econometrics and Statistics, Economic Modelling, European Financial Management, Financial Innovation, Financial Research Letters, International Journal of Finance & Economics, International Journal of Theoretical and Applied Finance, International Review of Finance, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance, Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions & Money, Quantitative Finance, Review of Managerial Science.
Conference Organizer	2026 ABFER-JFDS Conference on AI for Finance 2025 and 2026 USTC Frontiers in Finance Conference 2023 Workshop on Empirical Asset Pricing, College of Finance and Statistics, Hunan University
Program Committee	2022, 2024, 2025, 2026 FMA Annual Meeting
Session Chair	2022 INFORMS Annual Meeting Indianapolis

Miscellaneous

Programming	Python, R, MATLAB, C++, SAS, Linux, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Microsoft Office
Database	CRSP, Compustat, IBES, TRACE, FISD, Wind, CSMAR
Hobby	Arsenal FC, Sports (fitness, jogging, soccer, basketball, go), Reading (geography, philosophy)

Presentation

2026	• Chinese Economists Society China Annual Meeting, SWUFE (2026/7, Chengdu) • Machine Learning in Finance and Econometrics, SWUFE (2026/6, Chengdu) • The 6th Greater China Area Finance Conference, Xiamen University (2026/6, Xiamen) • SoFiE Annual Conference, University of Macau (2026/6, Macau) • Hong Kong Conference on Fintech and AI in Finance (2026/6, HK) • Invited Seminar, PBC School of Finance, Tsinghua University (2026/4, Beijing)
2025	EUROFIDAI-ESSEC Paris December Finance Meeting (2025/12, Paris); Fudan International Symposium on AI in Finance, Fudan University (2025/11, SH); Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech, Sun Yat-sen University (2025/10, Guangzhou); FinTech and Financial Markets Workshop, University of Macau (2025/10, Macau); Invited Seminar, Antai College, Shanghai Jiao Tong University (2025/10, SH); Invited Practitioner Talk, AITOPIA (2024/7, Online); USTC Frontiers in Finance Conference, USTC (2025/7, Hefei); Invited Seminar, School of Management, USTC (2025/6, Hefei); Hong Kong Conference for Fintech, AI, and Big Data in Business (2025/5, HK); Invited Seminar, School of Management, USTC (2025/5, Hefei); Invited Seminar, Institute for Financial Studies, SWUFE (2025/4, Chengdu); Annual Meeting of Chinese Statistical Association of Young Scholars (2025/4, Jinan); Invited Seminar, School of Management, Xiamen University (2025/3, Xiamen); Invited Seminar, School of Economics, Sichuan University (2025/3, Chengdu)
2024	Young Scholar Asset Pricing Workshop, SOE, Xiamen University (2024/10, Xiamen); Invited Seminar, School of Finance, SWUFE (2024/5, Chengdu); Invited Seminar, School of Management, USTC (2024/3, Hefei)
2023	Invited Seminar, School of Management, Xiamen University (2023/11, Xiamen); AI and Big Data in Accounting and Finance Conference, XJTLU (2023/6, Suzhou); Financial Econometrics Conference, Lancaster University (2023/3, Lancaster)
2022	Australasian Finance & Banking Conference, UNSW (2022/12, Online); New Zealand Finance Meeting, AUT (2022/12, Online); 5th Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech, SYSU (2022/11, Online); China Finance Annual Meeting, SJTU (2022/10, Online); China International Risk Forum, DUFE (2022/7, Online); Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society in China, CUHK(SZ) (2022/6, Online); 6th PKU-NUS Annual International Conference on Quantitative Finance and Economics, NUS (2022/5, Online)
2021	China Finance Annual Meeting, Xiamen University (2021/10, Online); INFORMS Annual Meeting (2021/10, Online); Financial Management Association Annual Meeting (2021/10, Online); Seminar, City University of Hong Kong (2021/9, Hong Kong); SoFiE Financial Econometrics Summer School, NYU SH (2021/8, Online); China International Risk Forum, SWUFE (2021/7, Chengdu); 37th International Conference of the French Finance Association, Audencia Business School (2021/5, Online); 4th China Accounting and Finance Conference, Sichuan University (2021/4, Online); Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference, La Trobe University (2021/4, Online); Camphor Economic Society Seminar Beijing (2021/2, Online); Camphor Economic Society Seminar Fujian (2021/1, Online);

Discussion

2025	• “Deciphering the Impact of BigTech Consumer Credit” at Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech, Sun Yat-sen University, Guangzhou, China. • “Nonverbal Information in Expectation Management – A Multimodal Perspective (in Chinese)” at CFRC, Tsinghua University PBCSF, Beijing, China. • “Oil-Driven Greenium” at International Conference on Green Finance and ESG, at Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, Chengdu, China.
2024	• “Carbon Risk and the Cost of Debt” at Greater China Area Finance Conference, Xiamen University • “Investor Sentiment and Cryptocurrency Returns” at Greater China Area Finance Conference, Xiamen University
2023	• “Do Insurers Listen to Earnings Conference Calls? Evidence from the Corporate Bond Market” at XJTLU
2022	• “Abnormal Downside Tail Risk as a Predictor of the Risky Bond Returns” at AFBC • “Financial Consequences of the Belt and Road Initiative” at NZFM • “Air Pollution and Bank Loan Pricing” at SYSU conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech • “Corporate Bond Pricing Using Interpretable and Arbitrage-Free Model” at CIRF
2021	• “Manager Uncertainty and the Cross-Section of Stock Returns” at FMA • “Does Reputation Matter? Evidence on Spatial Competition in China’s Bond Market” at FMCG
2020	• “How should we measure the performance of corporate bond mutual funds? Evaluating model quality and impact on inferences” at FMA

Last Update: June 7, 2026